João Lucas Almeida Pereira

Recife, PE, Brazil
Email: jlucasap@hotmail.com | Phone: +55 81 99546-8846
Portfolio: https://joao-lucas-ap.github.io/
LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/joao-lucas-almeida-pereira/ | GitHub: https://github.com/Joao-Lucas-AP

Professional Summary

Unity Developer and Gameplay Programmer with 4+ years of experience building, optimizing and shipping games on mobile, desktop and console. I like gameplay systems, performance work, and getting games to run well on hardware with tight limits. Shipped 5 commercial titles on Nintendo Switch, handling input, UI, save systems, localization and platform compliance. Master's in Software Engineering (LLMs in serious games). Comfortable with C#, C++, Unity, Unreal Engine 5 and GameMaker, and with working alongside designers, artists and QA.

Professional Experience

Game Nacional - Mid Game Developer

Apr 2024 – Present

- Ported and optimized **5 titles** for Nintendo Switch (Sunshine Farm, Tiny Little Farm, Felinea Tales, Pizza Maker, CatTerror), adapting input, UI and save systems to console constraints and platform compliance.
- Profiled and fixed performance and stability issues on real hardware (stutter, crashes, memory) using the Unity Profiler, frame debugger, object pooling and occlusion culling.
- Built gameplay features, UI flows and scene/prefab architecture in C# across commercial and academic Unity projects, and worked in GameMaker on console ports.
- Handled localization work, including Japanese support, Unity String Tables and text layout fixes.
- Debugged scripts, prefabs, animations and physics using structured, Git-based workflows.

GameForm - Game Developer / Game Designer / Concept Artist

Jul 2022 – Oct 2022

- Designed core gameplay systems, progression loops and reward structures for the mobile prototype of “Data2073”, including the card-based battle system and character mechanics.
- Created 120+ concept art assets and worked with the development team to align design and technical implementation.

Agência Combogó - Game Developer Jr

Mar 2022 – Jul 2022

- Developed a prototype of the mobile puzzle-platformer “O Resgate de Farya” for iOS and Android, in partnership with the animation studio ViuCine.

Relevant Projects

Sunshine Farm · Nintendo Switch port

https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/sunshine-farm-switch/

- 2D farm game ported to Nintendo Switch (GameMaker), published on the eShop.
- Worked on performance optimization, save system compatibility (async writes timed behind screen fades) and UI navigation for console controls.
- Fixed Japanese text overflow and font loading, and added Japanese to the localization pipeline.

ADHD Racers · Mar – Sep 2025

Demo video: ADHD Racers Project MVP - DEMO.mp4
Thesis (in Brazilian Portuguese): Adaptive Therapeutic AI: LLMs in serious games

- MVP of a 2D mobile racing game for my master's thesis.
- Built the full gameplay: top-down racing, minigame systems, REST API integration via UnityWebRequest, LLM communication and JSON serialization for adaptive responses and fast feedback.
- Validated the core game loop with mental health professionals.

CatTerror: The Abandoned House · Jan – Mar 2025
https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/catterror-the-abandoned-house-switch/
- 3D first-person horror game for Nintendo Switch.
- Optimized for Switch: lower texture resolution, object pooling, Unity Profiler and frame debugger, occlusion culling and view distance tuning.
- Adapted gameplay for Joy-Con and touchscreen input in minigames and item inspection.
- Fixed stutter and crashes caused by a monster instantiated on a collider trigger, by preloading the monster inactive and activating it on trigger.

Pizza Maker · Nov – Dec 2024
https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/pizza-maker-switch/
- 2D casual kitchen simulator with delivery and food design elements for Nintendo Switch.
- Adapted PC mouse control to a virtual cursor with UI interaction for Joy-Con, and adapted the save system for Switch.

Felinea Tales · Oct – Nov 2024
https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/felinea-tales-switch/
- 3D platformer for Nintendo Switch.
- Built the whole save system for Switch compatibility and improved localization by replacing external file reading with Unity String Tables.

Tiny Little Farm · May – Jun 2024
https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/tiny-little-farm-switch/
- 2D casual farm simulator for Nintendo Switch. Adapted the localization system to support Japanese.

Data2073 · Jul – Oct 2022
https://store.epicgames.com/p/data2073-9d83d4
- 3D Web3-focused card game with character positioning and skill targeting in a randomized environment.
- Prototyped the card battle system with ScriptableObjects, world-space location UI and mouse-to-world positioning of characters and abilities. Created 120+ concept art assets.

O Resgate de Farya · Mar – Jul 2022
https://oresgatedefarya.itch.io/o-resgate-de-farya
- 2D mobile puzzle-platformer made with ViuCine. Built a prototype with two playable characters and a non-generative AI-controlled companion, plus the mobile UI, core movement and AI systems.

Only Wheels · Feb – Jun 2020
https://joao-lucas-almeida.itch.io/only-wheels
- 3D racing prototype (university project) with a physics-based vehicle controller and a randomized power-up system. Built the cel shading pipeline and a custom water shader in Shader Graph.

Pugs and Plants · Aug – Nov 2019
https://joao-lucas-almeida.itch.io/pugs-and-plants
- My first full solo project: a hyper-casual 2D top-down shooter in Unity with wave-based spawning, scoring, ranking, life system and damage feedback UI, all systems in C#, UI in Unity UI Toolkit, plus all art and animations.

Technical Knowledge

Programming: C#, C++, SQL, Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), SOLID

Game Development: Gameplay Systems, Game Architecture, UI Systems, Input Systems, AI, Physics, Animation, Localization, Performance Optimization

Engines: Unity, Unreal Engine 5, GameMaker Studio

Graphics & VFX: Shader Graph, VFX Graph, Particle Systems, Rendering & Performance Optimization

Platforms: PC, Mobile (iOS/Android), Nintendo Switch, Console Porting

Tools & Workflow: Git, Visual Studio, VS Code, JIRA, Trello, Miro

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Education

Master's in Software Engineering — CESAR School | 2023 – 2025

Postgraduate Specialization in Game Development — Universidade Estácio de Sá | 2023 – 2024

Bachelor's Degree in Game Development — Universidade Católica de Pernambuco | 2019 – 2022

Languages

Portuguese: Native | English: Upper-Intermediate B2 (Cambridge CAE) | French: Basic A1